Marc-Anthony Bullock: Adult Career (2003-2006)

Volume 13 — locked in. From 2003 to April 2006 (ages 21-24), Marc works **only in family-friendly films, animated films, and voice work on *The Simpsons***. The work is acclaimed and successful, and it's also exactly why Hollywood still asks whether he can play a grown man (Volume 07). Every feature film is an original title made by a real studio.

1. Feature Films

Release	Title	Type	Studio	Role
Fri, Nov 21, 2003	*The Holiday Heir*	Live action	Warner Bros.	**Lead.** Nicholas “Nico” Grant, a 21-year-old toy-company heir sent to work in his own company's failing workshop the month before Christmas
Fri, Mar 12, 2004	*Featherweight*	Animated	Blue Sky Studios / 20th Century Fox	**Lead voice.** Kip, a young eagle who is afraid of heights
Fri, Aug 6, 2004	*Coach Junior*	Live action	Paramount / Nickelodeon Movies	**Lead.** Darius “D.J.” Hollins, a 22-year-old genius who takes over a hopeless middle-school basketball team
Wed, Nov 24, 2004 (Thanksgiving week)	*The Lighthouse Keeper's Kid*	Animated	Donohue Animation (before the 2005 family rule)	**Lead voice.** Toby, a boy who keeps a magical lighthouse lit through one long storm
Fri, Feb 11, 2005	*The Treasure of Copper Creek*	Live action	Walden Media / 20th Century Fox	**Lead.** Eli Porter, a young geologist leading a group of kids on a gold-rush treasure hunt
Fri, July 15, 2005	*Tumbleweed*	Animated	Warner Bros. Animation	**Lead voice.** Jack Rabbit, a fast-talking jackrabbit sheriff in an animated Western
Fri, Jan 20, 2006	*The Substitute Principal*	Live action	Paramount	**Lead, co-writer and producer.** Marcus Bell, a 24-year-old who becomes principal of his old middle school after a paperwork mistake and bends every ridiculous rule to save it
Fri, Nov 17, 2006 (upcoming)	*Starling*	Animated	DreamWorks Animation	**Lead voice.** Ziggy, a starling who leads a migrating flock home. In post-production.

The pattern Hollywood sees: heirs, coaches, mentors and talking animals. All of them are lovable and all of them are safe. Critics praise him (“Marc-Anthony makes family films feel like real films”), but casting directors only call with roles like these.

Highlights

- ***Featherweight*** (2004): his song “Higher Than Afraid” earns a Golden Globe nomination for Best Original Song, and he wins the Annie Award for voice acting in an animated feature.
- ***The Substitute Principal*** (2006): his first screenwriting and producing credit and his best reviews yet. Critics notice a more grown-up performance hidden inside a family comedy. It's the film Jon Favreau watches twice before Marc's *Iron Man* meeting.

- **Other awards:** Nickelodeon Kids' Choice Awards, NAACP Image Award nominations, and steady box office (every film is profitable).

2. *The Simpsons*: Royce Goodwell

Detail	Fact
Character	**Royce Goodwell**, voiced by Marc-Anthony Bullock
Who he is	A young Black billionaire and **the wealthiest man in the world**. He is the founder of Goodwell Global and is boundlessly generous, cheerful and unflappable. He is everything Mr. Burns is not, and he's richer.
Running gags	Mr. Burns's furious and endless attempts to get back the title of richest man. Royce solving every crisis by casually buying the problem. His deadpan pranks on Bart, which are always better than Bart's. His catchphrase: *"Put it on my tab."* (He owns the bank that holds the tab.)
Status	A **fan favorite** who becomes a **major recurring character for the rest of the show's run**
Behind the scenes	*The Simpsons* airs on Fox, a News Corp network, so the role is outside the Donohue family company. When Donohue buys 21st Century Fox in 2019, *The Simpsons* and Royce become Donohue property, and the press loves the irony.

The Debut: Season 15 (2003-2004)

Royce arrives in Springfield for something big. By the end of the episode he seems to be a one-off guest star. Then he keeps coming back that same season.

Air date	Episode	What happens
Sun, Jan 11, 2004	**"The Royce Is Right"** (debut)	The world's richest man flies into Springfield to buy the nuclear plant and turn it into a clean-energy showcase. Burns refuses to sell. Homer accidentally saves Royce's life and Lisa falls in love with his charity work. Royce outmaneuvers Burns, then helicopters away: *"Springfield, you've been a delight. I'll never need to come back!"* Everyone assumes he's a one-time guest star.
Sun, Feb 15, 2004	"Forbes and Grudges"	**Surprise return.** *Forbes* names Royce the richest man alive, and Burns comes up with an unhinged plan to bankrupt him. Royce answers by buying Burns a fruit basket, and the fruit basket also owns the bank.
Sun, Mar 28, 2004	"The Philanthropist's Stone"	Royce funds Lisa's science fair project. Lisa learns that giving money and giving a damn are two different things.
Sun, May 16, 2004	"Neighbor of the Year" (season finale)	Royce buys the empty mansion next to Burns Manor, **moves to Springfield for good**, and waves at Burns over the fence. It's the season's final shot.

Season 16 (2004-2005)

Air date	Episode	What happens
Sun, Nov 14, 2004	"Bart vs. the Billionaire"	Bart starts a prank war with Royce. Royce wins by scheduling his pranks a year in advance.
Sun, Jan 9, 2005	"Mo' Money, Mo' Moe"	Royce invests in Moe's Tavern, and Moe can't cope with being successful.
Sun, Feb 20, 2005	"The Wealth of Nations"	Royce accidentally buys Shelbyville, and Springfield panics.

Air date	Episode	What happens
Sun, Apr 10, 2005	“Homer Goodwell”	Royce hires Homer as his personal assistant. It goes about as well as you'd expect.
Sun, May 15, 2005	“Burns Notice” (season finale)	Burns fakes his own death to inherit Royce's sympathy. Royce throws Burns the best funeral in history while Burns watches.

Season 17 (2005-2006, airing now)

Air date	Episode	What happens
Sun, Sept 25, 2005	“Royce Against the Machine”	Burns builds a robot Royce to replace the real one.
Sun, Nov 6, 2005	*Treehouse of Horror XVI* segment	Royce is a vampire who only drains people's student debt.
Sun, Dec 11, 2005	“A Very Goodwell Christmas”	Royce gives everyone in Springfield what they actually need, and Burns gets coal, in the form of an energy company Royce bought him.
Sun, Mar 12, 2006	“Lisa's First Board Meeting”	Royce makes Lisa an honorary board member of Goodwell Global.
Sun, Apr 23, 2006	“The Burns Identity”	Burns tries to steal Royce's identity and finds out how many good deeds a day that requires.
Sun, May 21, 2006	Season finale (upcoming)	Not yet aired as of April 28, 2006.

Recognition

- Royce is regularly ranked among the best Simpsons characters of the 2000s. Marc wins a juried Primetime Emmy for Outstanding Voice-Over Performance (2005) and an Annie Award.
- **Looking ahead:** Royce appears in *The Simpsons Movie* (July 27, 2007) and in every season after that. He becomes one of the show's most important supporting characters through its present-day run.
- **The real-world irony:** in 2006 the most famous grown-up Marc-Anthony plays is a cartoon. Royce is witty, adult, rich and in control, which is basically Tony Stark without the armor. Jon Favreau mentions Royce in his first meeting with Marc.